

SEO & PUBLISHING METADATA

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| Suggested URL:      | /blog/india-medical-visa-guide-kenya-tanzania                                                                                                                                                               |
| Meta Title:         | India Medical Visa Guide for Kenyan & Tanzanian Patients 2026   Step-by-Step                                                                                                                                |
| Meta Description:   | Everything Kenyan, Tanzanian & East African patients need for an India medical visa in 2026 — eligibility, documents, fees, and how Heal India Medi Tourism handles the hospital invitation letter for you. |
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# India Medical Visa Guide for Kenyan & Tanzanian Patients (2026)

Every year, thousands of patients from Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, and across East Africa travel to India for treatment that's faster to access and a fraction of the cost of private care at home. The visa process is genuinely simple once you know the steps — this guide walks through exactly what's needed.

## Step 1: Confirm You're Eligible for the e-Medical Visa

Kenya and Tanzania are both on India's "fast-track" list of nationalities generally eligible for the **online e-Medical Visa**, which is faster and simpler than applying through the High Commission in person. This covers most planned treatment — cardiac, orthopedic, oncology, fertility, and similar specialties at a recognized Indian hospital.

Key facts about the e-Medical Visa:

- **Validity:** 60 days from your first arrival in India
- **Entries:** Triple entry (useful if you need a return trip for follow-up)
- **Processing time:** Commonly 24–72 hours once your documents are correct, though delays happen — apply early
- **Cost:** Government fee typically around \$80 USD for 6 months / \$120 USD for a 1-year validity Medical Visa (the standard e-Medical visa fee for shorter validity is generally lower — confirm current fees on the official portal, as they're revised periodically)
- **Companions:** Up to **two family members** can apply for a linked **e-Medical Attendant Visa**, sharing the same validity

## Step 2: Get Your Hospital Invitation Letter

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This is the single document your entire application depends on, and it's also the step where patients most often get stuck on their own. The letter must come from a **recognized Indian hospital**, on official letterhead, and include:

- Your full name and passport number (entered exactly as they appear in your passport)
- Your nationality
- A tentative admission or treatment date
- Confirmation that you're being accepted for medical treatment

Mismatched names or passport numbers between your documents are one of the most common causes of delay — double-check every field before submitting.

## Step 3: Gather Your Supporting Documents

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- Valid passport with **at least 6 months' validity** and a couple of blank pages
- A recent, square, white-background digital photo
- The hospital invitation letter (above)
- Your medical reports/referral from a local doctor (these also help your Indian specialist prepare a treatment plan before you even land)
- **Yellow fever vaccination certificate** — this is mandatory for travelers arriving from Kenya, Tanzania, and other yellow-fever-endemic countries; arriving without it can mean quarantine complications, so don't skip it

## Step 4: Apply Online

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1. Go to the official Government of India e-Visa portal ([indianvisaonline.gov.in](https://indianvisaonline.gov.in))
2. Complete the application with your passport and travel details exactly as they appear on your documents
3. Upload your photo and hospital invitation letter
4. Pay the visa fee
5. Note your application ID to track status

Apply **at least 4–7 days before your intended travel date** — applications can be submitted up to 120 days in advance, and earlier is always safer than later, especially if your treatment date is firm.

## Step 5: After You Arrive

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If your stay extends beyond a short visit, **all medical visa holders must register with the FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office) within 14 days of arrival.** Your hospital or coordinator can usually guide you through this — it's a standard administrative step, not a sign anything is wrong with your visa.

## Common Reasons Applications Get Delayed

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- Blurry passport or photo uploads
- Hospital letter missing required details (passport number, admission date)
- Name spelling mismatches between the passport and the application
- Payment not reflecting immediately — wait and check before reapplying

## Flight Connectivity from East Africa

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Direct flights from Nairobi and Dar es Salaam to Indian metro hubs (Mumbai, in particular) typically run around 5–6 hours, with one-stop options via Addis Ababa, Doha, or Dubai to other Indian cities — a genuinely manageable journey, even for patients traveling with a health condition.

## How Heal India Medi Tourism Makes This Easier

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This is exactly the part of the journey we exist to remove stress from:

1. **Share your medical reports on WhatsApp** — we coordinate directly with our partner hospital's international desk to get your invitation letter issued.
2. **We help you assemble and check your full document set** before you submit, to reduce the chance of delays from mismatched details.
3. **Airport pickup** in India and accommodation arranged for you and your attendant.
4. **Guidance on FRRO registration** if your stay requires it.
5. **A free, written treatment plan and cost estimate within 24 hours** of receiving your reports — so your visa application and your treatment plan move forward together, not separately.

## Frequently Asked Questions

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### **Do Kenyan and Tanzanian citizens need to visit the Indian High Commission in person?**

Not for the e-Medical Visa — it's a fully online application. In-person visits are typically only needed for visa categories outside the e-Visa system.

**Can my spouse or parent travel with me?**

Yes — up to two attendants can apply for a linked e-Medical Attendant Visa with matching validity.

**What if my treatment takes longer than 60 days?**

The e-Medical Visa allows triple entry within its 60-day validity; longer treatment plans may require a different visa category, which your hospital coordinator can advise on based on your specific treatment timeline.

**Is the yellow fever certificate really mandatory?**

Yes, for travelers arriving from yellow-fever-endemic countries including Kenya and Tanzania. Travel without it risking quarantine procedures on arrival — don't take the chance.

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**Planning treatment in India?** Send your medical reports on [WhatsApp](#) and we'll help with both your treatment plan and your hospital invitation letter — [request a free consultation](#) to get started.